



Eastern Canada

THE MOST INDUSTRIALIZED AND HEAVILY populated parts of Canada are in its eastern half. Ottawa, the capital, is located here, along with other important cities, such as Toronto, Montreal, and Québec. Some of the earliest settlers were French, and many people speak French as their first language. The Great Lakes—the largest system of lakes in the world—and the St Lawrence Seaway link the interior to the coast. The most easterly parts of Canada, the Atlantic Provinces, have rugged coastlines and dramatic scenery. However, soils are thin, so commercial agriculture is limited to a few areas. Fishing used to be the main activity, but fish stocks have been so depleted that few people are now employed in the industry, despite recent environmental efforts to rebuild the stocks. A growing oil and gas industry and new high-tech businesses are attracting younger workers, although many people still migrate to the bustling cities further inland.

Canadians have a high life expectancy—the average person lives to be 82 years old.

TORONTO
Toronto is Canada's most important economic center. Located on Lake Ontario, close to the US border, it is not only an industrial and commercial center but is also home to a wide diversity of ethnic and cultural groups. The Canadian National (CN) Tower, which dominates the Toronto skyline, is one of the world's tallest towers at 1,815 ft (553.33 m), and locals and tourists can get an impressive view of the city and Lake Ontario from the top.



ICE HOCKEY
Sports and leisure are important to Canadians. A popular sport is ice hockey, which thousands of people enthusiastically play or watch. Teams of skaters use long, curved sticks to try to get a hard rubber disc, called a puck, into the opposing team's goal. Both the men's and women's national ice hockey teams won gold medals at the Sochi 2014 Winter Olympics.



MAPLE SYRUP
The colorful maple trees of Québec and Ontario are tapped for maple syrup, a major export, and a popular topping on pancakes. The maple leaf is the national symbol of Canada and is featured on the nation's flag.



Maple sap collected from cuts in the tree trunk



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